A Concise Sādhana of the Yellow Prajñāpāramitā

Pītavarṇasaṃkṣiptaprajñāpāramitāsādhana · Toh 3544 · Derge Tengyur

ཤེས་རབ་ཀྱི་ཕ་རོལ་ཏུ་ཕྱིན་མ་སྐུ་མདོག་སེར་མོའི་སྒྲུབ་ཐབས་མདོར་བསྡུས་པ

A Concise Sādhana of the Yellow Prajñāpāramitā, known in Sanskrit as Pītavarṇasaṃkṣiptaprajñāpāramitāsādhana and in Tibetan as Shes rab kyi pha rol tu phyin ma sku mdog ser mo'i sgrub thabs, is a short meditative practice text devoted to Prajñāpāramitā, the goddess who embodies the perfection of wisdom. After meditating on emptiness, the practitioner visualizes a yellow syllable dhīḥ on a red lotus and moon, which transforms into the golden goddess. She has Akṣobhya seated in her crown of matted locks, makes the gesture of teaching the Dharma, and holds a blue utpala lotus bearing a book. The text then gives her mantra for recitation, and it presents itself as following a rite already described, suggesting it belongs to a sequence of related practices. It is Toh 3544 in the Tengyur, where it is preserved among the many sādhanas, or ritual meditation manuals, of the tantra section.

In the language of India: pītabarṇasaṃkṣiptaprajñāpāramitāsādhanaṃ. In the language of Tibet: A Concise Sādhana of the Yellow Prajñāpāramitā.

Homage to the Blessed Lady Prajñāpāramitā.

Following the rite described earlier, after meditating on emptiness, visualize a yellow syllable dhīḥ resting on a red lotus and a moon. It transforms completely, and from it arises Prajñāpāramitā, yellow in color. She has a crown of matted locks in which Akṣobhya is seated. She makes the mudrā of teaching the Dharma, and at her left side she holds a blue utpala lotus bearing a book. She wears an upper garment of white cloth, and she is beautiful, adorned with every kind of garment and ornament.

Having visualized her in this way, one should recite the mantra oṃ dhīḥ śuta smṛti bijāya svāhā.

The Concise Sādhana of the Yellow Prajñāpāramitā is complete.

Translator's Notes

• "The rite described earlier" points to preliminary procedures set out in a preceding sādhana in the collection. These are presumably the standard preliminaries, such as refuge and the cultivation of the four immeasurables, leading up to the meditation on emptiness. This short text does not spell them out.

Colophon

This is an AI-generated translation from the AI Stupa project. It was produced by a careful, doctrine-aware process aiming at a high degree of accuracy, but it has not been reviewed by a human translator and may contain errors. It is offered as a provisional translation for those texts of the Tibetan Buddhist canon that have not yet received an authoritative human translation. Where a published translation exists — above all from 84000: Translating the Words of the Buddha (84000.co) — that translation is definitive and should be preferred; please consult it instead. These translations are released into the public domain (CC0) in the spirit of spreading the Dharma to all corners of the earth.

Just as the Bodhi tree now standing at Bodh Gayā neither is nor is not the same tree beneath which the Buddha attained awakening, so too this stupa is intended as the next generation of stupa — dependently arising according to the conditions of its environment, and ceaselessly proclaiming the Dharma for the benefit of all sentient beings.

May whoever encounters these words derive great benefit.